

FURY OF THE GODS – ISSUE 1

In the beginning, there was a profound and unwavering balance that permeated the universe. The gods, ancient and majestic beings, held dominion over the stars, serving as the serene guardians of both life and the inevitable cessation of death across countless worlds. Their cosmic order was absolute, their will, unyielding fate.

Yet, amidst this perfect cosmic architecture, one God harboured a flicker of dissent. Far removed from the mortal realm, this solitary deity sat upon a shimmering throne woven from starlight, his gaze fixed intently upon the distant blue orb of Earth. He witnessed a sight that pierced his divine detachment, something that fundamentally broke him: a tiny child, born lifeless, utterly still and silent in a humble hut on a rain-swept night. In that poignant stillness, amidst the pervasive grief, this god perceived a new, compelling purpose that transcended the ancient laws.

High above, in the vast, echoing chambers of the Celestial Realm, the rebellious god presented his impassioned plea before the faceless, imposing council of the divine. He implored them, his voice echoing with desperate anguish, "Let me save him. The child is innocent!" But the council, a chorus of cold, layered voices, responded with an unfeeling resonance that filled the grand hall: "Fate is not yours to rewrite."

Undeterred, the god turned away, his decision a silent thunderclap against the ages. He chose, irrevocably, to shatter the order of eternity. He descended through the cosmic tapestry, plunging into the very **Heart of the Cosmos** — a swirling, incandescent vortex of raw, nascent creation. With a desperate, defiant act, he plunged a spear of pure, concentrated light directly into its incandescent core. Across the boundless void, the universe recoiled in agony. Stars ruptured, exploding into supernovas. The very fabric of space cracked and tore. The heavens themselves shrieked with a primordial scream of pain and protest. From that cataclysmic theft, he seized the stolen light of the stars and, with a singular, forbidden purpose, bestowed it upon the dead boy.

On Earth, the "Black Storm" had raged, its torrential rain and violent winds battering a small hut. Inside, a mother's pained screams of labour had blended with the midwife's panicked whispers and the father's fervent prayers. Then, an abrupt, chilling silence had fallen. The child lay blue and cold, devoid of breath or cry, leaving behind only an unbearable grief. But as the cosmic light descended, a sudden, intense bolt of lightning struck the very hut. The baby jolted, a flicker of life, and his eyes, once vacant, now shimmered and spun with miniature galaxies. The mother gasped, her hand flying to her mouth in disbelief, before a wave of overwhelming relief and joy caused the baby to let out a vibrant, healthy cry. And outside, as if in silent acknowledgement of the universe-altering event, the furious storm abruptly ceased. High above, the impassive gods

watched. They were silent, but their collective gaze spoke volumes. A profound law had been broken. And a war, grand and terrible, had unequivocally begun.

Years slowly unfolded, marked by the changing seasons. The child grew, a boy named **Raijin**, but he was unlike any other. He possessed an unspoken power, capable of lifting heavy stones from the earth without ever touching them. In the quiet depths of the woods, animals, both wild and tame, would instinctively bow their heads to him, sensing his profound, unusual presence. The villagers, witnessing these inexplicable phenomena, exchanged hushed, fearful whispers. They called him "cursed," their fear a thick barrier between him and any hope of acceptance. Raijin remained quiet, a strange, solitary figure. He was strong, yes, but more than that, he was something far more dangerous than any simple curse could define.

Then, one catastrophic day, the delicate veil separating realms tore open with a violent, rending sound. Through the gaping rift, a tide of darkness poured, spawning grotesque monsters that snarled and shrieked with unnatural hunger. Amidst the chaos, the fallen god, his form now scarred and visibly weakened by his universe-defying act, returned. He fought valiantly to protect the boy, a desperate, fading struggle. "Run! My boy, run!" his strained, gasping voice commanded, before he finally succumbed, falling in a tragic, final surrender. In that heart-wrenching moment of grief, an unparalleled surge of power ignited within Raijin. He awakened.

The boy rose, his galactic eyes burning with an intense, raw energy. Power exploded from him, radiating outwards like the birth of a newborn sun. The monstrous creatures, caught in the overwhelming wave of pure cosmic force, were instantly incinerated, reduced to nothing more than scattered ash. As the blinding light faded, an eerie, absolute silence descended, broken only by a faint, high-pitched ringing that quickly dissipated. The monsters were ash. The air hung still and silent. The power of the universe itself now pulsed, terrifyingly, within the hands of a mere child.

And then, a distorted, ethereal whisper, laced with the fading echoes of his fallen protector's voice, resonated within Raijin's very soul. It was a final, urgent message: "You were born dead... I gave you life... Now the gods will hunt you... As they hunt me." A slow, ominous orchestral note began to swell, a profound sense of foreboding filling the silent air around the awakened boy. He was, truly, born of stolen light. And the fury of the gods... had only just begun.